BATMAN

The Dark Knight of Gotham City

Overview

Batman is a fictional superhero published by DC Comics. Created by artist Bob Kane and writer Bill Finger, the character first appeared in *Detective Comics* #27 in May 1939. He is one of the most recognizable and enduring characters in popular culture.

Origin

Bruce Wayne is a wealthy young heir in Gotham City who witnesses the murder of his parents, Thomas and Martha Wayne, in a street crime. The trauma drives him to train his body and mind to the peak of human ability and to wage a lifelong war on crime. He chooses the bat as his symbol to strike fear into criminals.

Abilities and Equipment

Batman has no superpowers. His strengths are genius-level intellect, detective skills, martial arts mastery, physical conditioning, and vast wealth. His gear includes a armored suit and cowl, a utility belt, grappling gadgets, and the Batmobile.

Key Facts

Real name	Bruce Wayne
First appearance	Detective Comics #27 (1939)
Creators	Bob Kane and Bill Finger
Home city	Gotham City
Allies	Alfred Pennyworth, Robin, Batgirl, Commissioner Gordon
Notable foes	The Joker, Two-Face, The Penguin, Catwoman, Bane, The Riddler

Batman in Other Media

Batman has starred in animated series, live-action television, video games, and many films, including those directed by Tim Burton, Christopher Nolan, and Matt Reeves. The *Batman: Arkham* game series and *Batman: The Animated Series* are widely praised.

Legacy

For more than eight decades Batman has stood for justice, resilience, and the idea that a person can turn pain into purpose. His stories explore fear, morality, and the cost of vengeance, which keeps him relevant to new generations.